

tions, this otherwise rarely-used feature can now be put to good use. Of course, using Active Desktop hides the wallpaper.

To use an Active Desktop, enable this in the Display Properties window (**Display properties > Desktop > Customize Desktop > Web**). One can load any Web site as the Desktop, and changes to the site are reflected on the Desktop. This feature is most useful for constantly-updated sites like news sites or stock market tracking sites.

10.1 Electronic Post-it Notes

With a PC in front of you, hunting for an elusive post-it note is unnecessary—when you want to quickly jot down something, use Notepad. But this application has two features that make it unsuitable for spontaneous note-taking—it doesn't save itself, and it cannot be “pinned.”

Electronic versions of 3M's legendary Post-it Notes fill a real convenience void. They are an able companion to anyone using a PC: they offer an easily-accessible storage space for data on your Desktop without having to bother saving it.

One of the golden oldies in this software category was TurboNote. This application is no longer free, and is offered as a 30-day trial or as sponsorware. Finding an earlier, free version of TurboNote would be a worthwhile endeavour.

Features common to electronic Post-it Notes are:

- They are usually resident in the System Tray, and can be launched in a jiffy, either by a hotkey or a single click.
- The notes can be placed anywhere on the screen, and remain rooted to the spot unless repositioned by the user. They make for little obstruction to the rest of the activities on the system, either by becoming transparent or by minimising automatically when not in use.
- The appearance is changeable—background colours, fonts, etc.